

Total Fertility Rate (TFR)

The Total Fertility Rate (TFR) refers to the average number of live births a female would have by the end of her reproductive period if she were to experience the prevailing age-specific fertility rates throughout her reproductive life.

Table 9.15 shows the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) of women in the reproductive age group, based on information collected at the Population and Housing censuses in 1981, 2012 and 2024.

Table 9.15 : Total Fertility Rate (TFR), 1981, 2012 and 2024

Year	Total Fertility Rate (TFR)
1981	3.3
2012	2.4
2024	1.3

In 1981, the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) was reported as 3.3. By 2012, it had declined to 2.4, and by 2024 it had further decreased to 1.3.

Figure 9.4 shows the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) of married females aged 15 years and over, by sector, ethnic group and educational level, based on the Census of Population and Housing 2024.

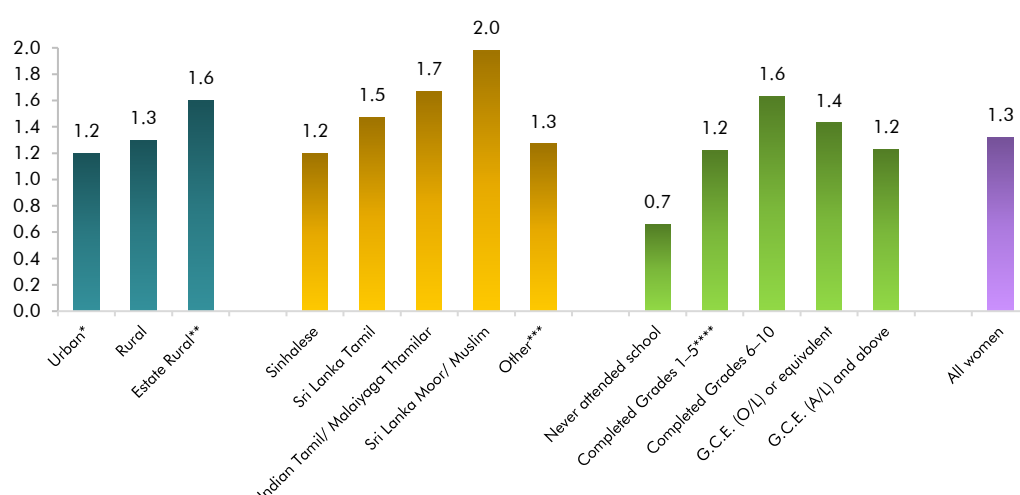


Figure 9.4 : Total Fertility Rate (TFR) by Sector, Ethnic Group and Educational Level, 2024

* In 2024 information was collected separately for "Urban" and "Estate Urban" sectors, for comparison with the 2012 Census data, these two sectors have been combined and presented as "Urban".

** In the 2012 Census, the sector was identified as "Estate", whereas in the 2024 Census it is referred to as "Estate Rural."

***Others - Burghers, Malays, Sri Lanka Chetties, Bharatas, VEDAS and other mentioned ethnic groups are mentioned under this.

**** Those studying/obtained in Grade 1 and those studying/obtained in a special school or special unit are also included in this category.

The Total Fertility Rate (TFR) among females in the estate sector is reported as 1.6, which is significantly higher than the fertility levels of females in the urban and rural sectors. The Total Fertility Rate among Sri Lanka Moor/ Muslim women is 2.0, which is the highest among all ethnic groups. Furthermore, by ethnic group, Sinhalese women show the lowest fertility rate, with a TFR of 1.2.

Analysis of fertility by the educational level of married females shows that females who have never attended school have lower fertility levels compared to those with primary, secondary, or higher educational qualifications. The highest fertility rate is observed among females who have completed grades 6–10, with a TFR of 1.6. Females with GCE Advanced Level (A/L) and higher education have a TFR of 1.2.